COSMOS IN NUMBERS · FREE SKY CALENDAR

The Next 30 Nights

Nov 14 to Dec 13, 2026

What you can see with your own eyes, and when. No telescope, no app.

The planets

5 of 5 visible this period · for mid-northern latitudes (40° N)

Mercury	**Before dawn, low in the south-east before sunrise; by the end of the period: hidden in the Sun's glare.** In Virgo, magnitude -0.1, as bright as the brightest stars.
Venus	**Before dawn, midway up in the south-east before sunrise.** In Virgo, magnitude -4.4, brighter than every star.
Mars	**Before dawn, high in the south before sunrise; by the end of the period: before dawn, high in the south-west before sunrise.** In Leo, magnitude 0.7.
Jupiter	**Before dawn, high in the south before sunrise; by the end of the period: before dawn, high in the south-west before sunrise.** In Leo, magnitude -2, as bright as the brightest stars.
Saturn	**Evening, midway up in the south-east after sunset.** In Cetus, magnitude 0.6.

A planet shines with a steady light; stars twinkle. Magnitude: the lower the number, the brighter the object.

NIGHTS WORTH GOING OUT

Dates to circle

UTC: where you live it can be the night before or after

Nov 17	First quarter Moon: half lit in the evening, the best phase to see craters with binoculars.
Nov 17	Leonids peak: up to 15 meteors an hour under a perfect dark sky, debris of Comet Tempel-Tuttle. Moon 55% lit: some moonlight. Best after midnight.
Nov 24	Full Moon, 360,800 km away. A supermoon: closer than usual, so slightly bigger and brighter.
Nov 30	The Moon (60% lit) passes about 1° from Jupiter: the easiest way to find the planet.
Nov 30	The Moon (56% lit) passes about 3° from Mars: the easiest way to find the planet.
Dec 1	Last quarter Moon: rises around midnight, evenings stay dark.
Dec 9	New Moon: the darkest nights of the month, best for faint stars and the Milky Way.

HOW TO USE THIS PAGE

1. Start with the Moon.
On the dates when the Moon passes a planet, the bright "star" next to it is that planet. Once you have found it that night, you will find it again on any other.

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2. Evening or before dawn.
"Evening" means from about 45 minutes after sunset. "Before dawn" means the last hour of the night, before the sky brightens.

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3. For meteors, look at the whole sky.
Lie back, keep your phone away so your eyes adapt to the dark, and give it at least half an hour. The quoted rates are for a perfect dark sky: from a town you will see fewer.

Want to know what everything else up there is?

LOOK UP is our 173-page beginner's guide to the night sky: how to find the main stars and constellations, another galaxy with ordinary binoculars, a month-by-month 2027 calendar and the total solar eclipse of 2 August 2027. No telescope needed.

Get LOOK UP → cosmosinnumbers.gumroad.com/l/look-up

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Computed with PyEphem for 40° N. Meteor shower peaks and rates: IMO Meteor Shower Calendar. Dates are UTC and can shift by one day where you live. Planet positions are for 45 minutes after sunset or before sunrise. The layout and the calculations were made with the help of AI tools; no organisation cited endorses this page. Free to share unchanged with credit to Cosmos in Numbers.